MGM Cancer Institute

WE CURE FEAR FIRST

DR. M.A. RAJA
LEADING THE FIGHT AGAINST CANCER AT MGM CANCER INSTITUTE

India's premier practitioner of Medical Oncology has stayed true to his vision of what a doctor's core function is. As a 6 year old, the unique power that his grandfather had to make sad people happy, is what attracted him to this profession. He has fastidiously been pursuing this as his professional objective, for the past 4 decades.



DR. M.A. RAJA
Senior Consultant, Medical Oncology,
Director Oncology Services,
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Venturing into Oncology 40 years ago when it was a nascent field, Dr. M. A. Raja, Senior Consultant, Medical Oncology, Director Oncology Services, MGM Cancer Institute has been a ringside witness to the growth of this field. Having a domain expertise in virtually every type of tumour, he is the most competent person to talk about Cancer as a whole.

In his characteristic "cut the clutter" manner, he has simplified the approach to this condition. He says it needs to be handled in a humane manner where empathy matters the most. Cancer he says mainly of two types. The ones that you can totally avoid and the ones that you can take precautions against. Cancer of the Cervix can be eliminated by following a good hygiene practise of a daily wash. High of the list is a pap smear test once in a couple of years, at your Gynecologist's place to stay safe. Hepatitis that causes complications leading to liver tumour can be avoided by taking a course of immunity doses.

For the rest, Dr. M. A. Raja recommends a concerted approach that consists of preventive approach, screening and the predictive approach.

Eschewing tobacco, alcohol and consuming fats and sugar just as much as it is needed, is the secret. Dr. M. A. Raja says, "Food itself is a major cause. The wrong kind of food and the wrong quantity of food are major culprits". Fat deposition is like a cancer magnet. Sedentary lifestyles that promote obesity due to a lack of physical activity is another major red flag for him. He advices, "Eat for your body, not for enjoyment. People go for the color, the aroma, the ambience or the packaging and ignore it's nutritional value". If we get our priorities right and follow a right lifestyle, the probability of contacting cancer reduces drastically.

At MGM Hospitals he has been spearheading a humanitarian approach where their first task is to educate, advice and help cancer patients and their families to overcome and conquer the fear that the disease instills. The scientific process may follow a 2 stage process that starts with a biopsy to establish the infection, followed by a gene profiling conducted in parallel to identify the gene that has undergone an irreversible change leading to the condition.

Advances in technology enables Dr. M. A. Raja's team to identify the treatments that will work the best and those that will not. They then draw up personalised regimen that serves the patient the best. With top notch multimodal capabilities delivered by experts in surgery, radiology and medicine who specialise in oncology, the outcomes are extremely encouraging.

The Predictive nature of the gene profiling exercise goes a long way in helping in entire family. If it establishes that a hereditary gene is the one that has undergone a transformation, Dr. M. A. Raja is able to advice and guide the most vulnerable family members on precautionary steps that they need to take to ensure a healthy life.

Following a holistic approach that is an optimal mix of preventive, predictive and medical treatments, Dr. M. A. Raja and his team have consistently been putting smiles in the faces of people. He confesses, "That's what keeps us going. Everyday is a new day. We become a part of families and share their joys."

We say, that's what excellence is all about.



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